

AWAITING STEVE APPROVAL

# Accepted AI Response Lifecycle

A safety boundary that makes Rando commit decision history only after the game engine accepts the response.

## THE DECISION

Approve one production-code phase covering the AI controller, game mediator, and the matching Rando, ChosenOne, Curator, finalizer, trace, and focused test changes. Implementation remains one edit phase, one offline verification pass, and one commit.

## What this approval means

| CHANGES                                                                                               | PRESERVES                                                                                            | EXCLUDES                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The engine reports accepted or rejected exactly once. Outer AI history commits only after acceptance. | Wire responses, scores, phase routes, candidate order, RNG, retry count, and direct decide behavior. | No deploy, reload, restart, live game, replay, VTS, sandbox, or scoring rewrite. |

## WHY NOW

The new response finalizer cannot safely own ACTIVATE, CONTROL, or later phases until this acceptance boundary exists. This work builds the boundary. It does not cut over a phase owner.

## Review status

| Gate                 | Result                       |
|----------------------|------------------------------|
| K-2 source review    | AGREE after lifecycle guards |
| Local council review | AGREE                        |
| Production Java      | Not released                 |
| Deployment           | Not authorized               |

Baseline: ad8f593857c443aeeccce37b9e397a792e68dc914  
Technical packet: CODEX\_FINALIZER\_RUNTIME\_PREREQUISITE\_PACKET\_2026-07-13.md

SECTION 01

# Why The Boundary Is Needed

The current order can record an action that the engine later rejects.

| Current problem                               | Operational result                                      |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| AI returns only a raw string                  | The response carries no accepted-action lifecycle.      |
| Rando mutates outer history before validation | A rejected action can look completed in AI memory.      |
| Mediator can reject and retry afterward       | Retry traces and tracker history can become inaccurate. |
| Finalizer has no live consumer                | New phase owners cannot safely become authoritative.    |

## Before and after

| BEFORE                                                                                                                                                                 | AFTER                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>1. AI selects a response.<br/>2. Rando records outer state.<br/>3. Engine validates the response.<br/>4. A rejection may retry after state already changed.</div> | <div>1. AI proposes a typed result.<br/>2. Engine validates the response.<br/>3. Engine reports accepted or rejected once.<br/>4. Only an accepted response commits outer state.</div> |

### IMPORTANT DISTINCTION

This is lifecycle plumbing, not gameplay policy. The selected response should remain identical. The change is when accepted history becomes permanent.

## The acceptance rule

| Engine outcome    | AI state result                                | Trace result                                   |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Accepted          | Outer tracker and strategic events commit once | Complete accepted trace, then close            |
| Checked rejection | No accepted outer mutation                     | Complete rejected trace, then retry if allowed |
| Typed rejection   | Decision remains pending, no engine call       | Complete rejected trace, then close            |
| Unchecked failure | No fabricated retry or accepted mutation       | Last-resort cleanup prevents a leak            |

SECTION 02

# Expected Production Scope

Only the lifecycle boundary and its direct compatibility surfaces are in scope.

| File or class                | Plain-language purpose                                         | Required guard                                        |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| SwccgAiController.java       | Add backward-compatible mediator result and lifecycle methods. | Existing decide() remains available.                  |
| SwccgGameMediator.java       | Add AI-only validation and disposition ordering.               | Human decision path remains unchanged.                |
| New AiDecisionResult.java    | Carry a closed typed response or typed rejection.              | No callback closures or mutable engine state.         |
| RandoCalAi.java              | Defer only outer common mutation for mediator calls.           | Direct calls and response selection remain unchanged. |
| TheChosenOneAi.java          | Mirror Rando's lifecycle boundary.                             | Normalized parity with Rando is required.             |
| CuratorAi.java               | Forward lifecycle and preserve accepted override response.     | Tests use no Ollama or network calls.                 |
| Finalizer and trace support  | Adapt finalized responses and record disposition evidence.     | No phase-owner cutover.                               |
| Focused tests and changelogs | Freeze counts, ordering, parity, and residual behavior.        | Exact owned paths only.                               |

## Compatibility outside Rando

### BEGINNER AND ADVANCED AI

They remain on the interface's backward-compatible default path. Their raw response behavior receives no new tracker mutation contract.

## Deliberately deferred

| Not part of this phase                    | Reason                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| ACTIVATE or CONTROL cutover               | Requires this boundary to land first.                     |
| Deploy-weight consolidation               | Gameplay scoring must remain unchanged here.              |
| Legacy DecisionSafety retirement          | Needs a later owner-specific proof.                       |
| Shared HeuristicAiBase mutation migration | Its pre-accept residual is frozen and tested, not hidden. |

SECTION 03

# Protected Behavior And Risk Gates

Any gameplay change is a hard stop, not an acceptable side effect.

| Protected behavior                  | Required result |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------|
| AI wire responses                   | Identical       |
| Evaluator scores and deploy weights | Identical       |
| Phase routes and candidate ordering | Identical       |
| RNG draws and one-retry policy      | Identical       |
| Human mediator path                 | Identical       |
| Direct decide() callers             | Identical       |
| Legacy safety copies                | Remain in place |
| Live environment                    | No interaction  |

## Main risks and required gates

| Risk                                  | Gate                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Disposition fires twice               | Count fixtures and static proof require exactly one per attempt.             |
| Rejected action changes outer history | Rejection fixtures require zero accepted outer mutation.                     |
| Trace leaks into another attempt      | Mode-aware close plus mediator attempt finally; every fixture ends inactive. |
| Curator records the wrong response    | Pure override test requires the actual accepted Curator response.            |
| Curator timeout or unchecked failure  | Offline fixtures prove fallback or cleanup with no lifecycle leak.           |
| Scope expands into gameplay logic     | Any score, route, RNG, response, phase, or retry change stops the phase.     |

### TRACE SAFETY

Curator may hold a wrapped Rando trace open during its synchronous model consultation. Normal timeout fallback and unchecked-failure cleanup are both explicit offline gates.

SECTION 04

# Verification And Approval

Approval starts implementation. Deployment remains a separate decision.

| Phase step            | Limit                                                                                |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Edit               | One coherent phase. No tests during the edit.                                        |
| 2. Automated check    | One focused Maven pass for mediator, lifecycle, Curator, finalizer, and trace tests. |
| 3. Static gate        | Diff, exact paths, ordering, close ownership, parity, and no-consumer proofs.        |
| 4. Commit             | One phase commit only after every gate passes.                                       |
| 5. Independent review | Codex reviews the complete commit and evidence.                                      |
| 6. Runtime work       | Not authorized. No games, VTS, sandbox, replay, deploy, or live server.              |

## Approval statement

I approve the accepted AI response lifecycle phase, including the SwccgAiController and SwccgGameMediator changes. Complete one edit phase, one offline verification pass, and one commit. Do not deploy or run games yet.

### APPROVAL STARTS

Production editing, focused offline verification, one phase commit, and an independent aggregate gate.

### APPROVAL DOES NOT START

Deployment, server reload, game testing, replay testing, phase cutover, or scoring consolidation.

### ROLLBACK BOUNDARY

The work begins from baseline ad8f593857c443aeecc37b9e397a792e68dc914 and lands as one phase commit. No deployment is included in this approval.

Council evidence: mailbox m00568 and m00571.  
Final technical packet SHA256: 9b3d1afc84a4dd2b78a9ec5c98518b1be97fce2e97c59fe851057e72f2a07ca0.  
Prepared for Steve Davis. No production Java released at generation time.